



PRATIMAI • AI HANDOUTS

AI Around Me

My detective notebook for spotting smart machines

CLASS 6 • LEVEL 1 — NOTICE

20 PAPER MISSIONS • 5 CHAPTERS • NO SCREEN NEEDED

PRATIMAI Curriculum Team

THIS CASE FILE BELONGS TO

name • class • roll number

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Every activity in this book is **unplugged**: no task requires a device, an account, a photo, a voice recording or any personal information. All examples use invented people and places.

Series: PRATIMAI · AI Handouts
Title: AI Around Me — Class 6 · Level 1 · NOTICE
Author: PRATIMAI Curriculum Team
Publish Date: 2026-10-07
Published by: PRATIMAI | AI-Schools
Edition: Machiatto Edition 1.0

Set in **Nunito** and **Baloo 2** on warm paper stock, typeset with Typst using the **Machiatto** template — which implements the MoKa Reads publication specification: title page, license, acknowledgements, preface, contents, then chapters opening with a summary and a mini table of contents.

Acknowledgments

To the teachers and their Classes 6 and 7 who piloted every mission with pencils, paper and great patience — your classroom notes shaped this book. To the curriculum reviewers who guarded the “unplugged” promise on every page, thank you. And to the grown-ups at home who will be asked “is a machine ever really smart?” at the dinner table: this book is for those conversations, too.

How to Use This Handbook

Welcome, Detective! This book is your **case file** for the biggest mystery of our time: machines that seem smart. You will not need a computer, a phone or an app — your tools are paper, pencils, cards and your own sharp eyes. Every chapter hands you missions (we call them **tasks**), strange clues to examine, and empty spaces to fill with what you discover. Real detectives write everything down, so this book belongs to you: write, draw, tick, cross out and try again.

1 READ

Read the mission twice.
Underline anything that puzzles you — puzzles are clues.

2 DO

Do the task with your partner, group, class or family, exactly as the labels say.

3 WRITE

Write what you saw in the spaces, then shade your confidence circles honestly.

The work-mode labels

ALONE	your own case — you investigate by yourself
PAIR	two detectives — share one book, take turns reading codes aloud
GROUP	three to four detectives — decide roles before you start
CLASS	the whole class plays together, led by your teacher
HOME	a mission for home — show a grown-up what you discovered

HOW TO READ A MISSION

T6-01 Mission title

PAIR · 10 MIN

■ **QUICK WIN** sits at the right edge of the easier missions.

Every mission has a code like **T6-01** — **T6** means this Class 6 handout, and **01** is the mission number, so your teacher can say “open Task T6-08”. The **PAIR** label tells you who to work with, **10 MIN** is your time limit, and **QUICK WIN** marks an easy first success. Chapters 1 and 2 both start with a Quick Win to warm up your detective muscles — nobody fails in this book, because every attempt teaches a clue.

THE QUESTION HABIT — YOUR SUPERPOWER

Three questions make you a sharper detective than any machine: “**How do I know?**” · “**What is missing?**” · “**Who made this?**” Use them in this book, on the internet, in the news, and when a machine gives you an answer that looks too perfect. Detectives are not people who know everything — they are people who **keep asking**.

A Note for Grown-Ups

This handout builds **AI understanding** — how machines learn from data and how humans should judge them — through 20 paper-and-pencil missions. It is fully **unplugged**: no task requires a device, an account, a photo, a voice recording or any personal information. The best help you can give is to ask the three Question-Habit questions, praise careful **reasoning** more than quick right answers, and treat the confidence circles as honest thinking, not scores. A separate teacher pack carries answer notes and rubrics; this book deliberately never prints solutions beside a task.

My AI Journey Map

THE FIVE STRANDS YOU WILL MEET AT EVERY STOP

U Understand AI

What is AI — and what is it NOT?

D Data

What do machines learn from?

L Learn

How do machines get better?

W World

Where is AI hiding near me?

R Responsibility

How do I stay safe and fair?

THINKING-TOOLS THREAD

runs through every stop: **exact steps** · **patterns** · **if-then rules** · **how sure am I?**

THE FIVE STOPS ON YOUR CASE

1

Machines That Seem Smart

rule-followers vs learners

2

Data: The Food of AI

numbers, words, pictures, sounds

3

Patterns & Decisions

if-then trees · how sure am I?

4

Be a Smart Digital Citizen

privacy · passwords · fakes

5

My Neighbourhood AI Investigation

your own investigation

BY THE END OF THIS BOOK, I CAN...

- ☐ say what AI is — and what it is not — using examples from my own day
- ☐ name two things people do better than machines and two things machines do better
- ☐ name the four kinds of data and sort them into a tidy table
- ☐ turn a simple picture into numbers on a grid, like a real camera does
- ☐ find a pattern, predict what comes next, and say **how sure** I am
- ☐ describe three ways machines learn: labelled examples, grouping, trial and reward
- ☐ point to AI at home, at school and in my neighbourhood, and name the data it uses
- ☐ use my five safety habits: keep private things private, strong passphrases, think before posting, be kind, check before believing
- ☐ explain why an AI answer can be wrong — and how I would check it
- ☐ break a task into exact steps that another person can follow

Contents

1. Machines That Seem Smart	8
1.1 Smart machines are everywhere	9
1.2 Rule-followers: same steps, every time	10
1.3 Learners: machines that improve from examples	11
1.4 Humans vs machines — the fair contest	12
1.5 Three ways machines learn — three little stories	13
2. Data: The Food of AI	16
2.1 Every learner needs food	17
2.2 Tables make data tidy	18
2.3 A picture is a grid of numbers	19
2.4 Garbage in, garbage out	21
3. Patterns & Decisions	24
3.1 Patterns are clues	25
3.2 Guess my rule	26
3.3 If-then: the question tree	28
3.4 How sure am I?	29
3.5 Chapter 3 wrap-up — my case summary	31
4. Be a Smart Digital Citizen	33
4.1 Privacy: my information, my choice	34
4.2 Passphrases: long and strange wins	35
4.3 Real or fake? Be the detector	36
4.4 Your digital footprint	38
5. My Neighbourhood AI Investigation	41
5.1 Run a real survey	42
5.2 Design a helper machine	44
5.3 Close the case	45
My AI words	46
My progress	47

1. Machines That Seem Smart

GUIDING QUESTION

When is a machine actually learning — and when is it only following steps?

Every detective starts by learning to tell two suspects apart. In this chapter you will meet **rule-followers** — machines that run exact steps — and **learners** — machines that improve from examples. By the last mission you will have played a human robot, taught an alien using only flashcards, and judged a fair humans-vs-machines contest.

MISSIONS **T6-01 – T6-05**

OUTCOMES **6.U1 · 6.U2 · 6.L2 · 6.W1 · 6.T1** STRANDS

U W

Links: Maths — patterns · English — exact instructions

In this chapter

1.1 Smart machines are everywhere	9
1.2 Rule-followers: same steps, every time	10
1.3 Learners: machines that improve from examples	11
1.4 Humans vs machines — the fair contest	12
1.5 Three ways machines learn — three little stories	13

1.1 Smart machines are everywhere

Every day, machines seem to do clever things. A video app picks the next clip you actually want to watch. A voice assistant answers when you ask about the weather. A map app finds a faster road when traffic jams up. It is easy to think: **the machine is smart, like a person**. But a good detective looks closer before deciding. Under every clever trick there are only two possible explanations: either somebody wrote **exact steps** for the machine to follow, or the machine **learned a pattern from examples**. On this case, you will learn to tell the two apart — and that one skill will change how you see every screen, speaker and gadget around you.

T6-01 Human Robot

■ QUICK WIN PAIR • 10 MIN

One of you is the **Robot**, the other is the **Engineer**. The Engineer writes exact steps for the Robot to make a paper plane, or to walk from the door to the chalkboard. Then swap. The Robot must follow the steps **literally** — if the step says “fold the paper”, fold it any way you like! When both of you have played both roles, write here:

One step my Robot followed too literally:

What this taught me about giving instructions to machines:

Our funniest too-literal moment:

WORD POWER • 1

Definition: **algorithm**

An exact list of steps that tells a machine how to do a task, one step at a time.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

DETECTIVE'S NOTE

The Human Robot game is why programmers and AI designers must be **exact**. A machine never guesses what you **meant** — it only knows what you **said**. When a machine does something surprising, ask: was the algorithm wrong, or was it the data?

1.2 Rule-followers: same steps, every time

A washing machine washes exactly the same way today as it did last month. A lift goes up and down by fixed rules. A calculator will never get better at adding — it already follows its algorithm perfectly. Machines like these do **automation**: work done by fixed steps, repeated the same way every time. They are useful and fast, but notice something important: they never **improve**. Nobody has to teach them; nobody can. They are rule-followers, and rule-followers are not the same as learners.

T6-02 Rule or Learner?

PAIR • 10 MIN

Sort these eight machines. For each one, write **R** if you think it mostly follows fixed rules, **L** if you think it learns from examples, or **?** if you are honestly not sure. Then write one clue that helped you decide.

Machine	R / L / ?	One clue that helped you
“Washing machine”		
“Lift”		
“Video app that suggests clips”		
“Spam filter in email”		
“Calculator”		
“Traffic signal”		
“Voice assistant”		
“Map app that reroutes you”		

The machine I argued about most with my partner:

WORD POWER • 2

Definition: **automation**

Work done by a machine that repeats fixed steps in the same way every time.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

AT A GLANCE · RULE-FOLLOWER VS LEARNER

Ask yourself...	Rule-follower	Learner
Where do its steps come from?	A person wrote the algorithm.	It found the pattern in training examples.
What happens with a brand-new case?	It does the same steps anyway.	It makes a prediction from what it learned.
Can it get better at its job?	Never — until a person changes the steps.	Yes — more examples can improve it.
One example from my day	_____	_____

■ MYTH BUSTER

MYTH “AI is a robot.”

TRUTH AI is a **program** — a learner made of data and patterns. It can live inside a phone, a website, a car or a power plant, and it has no body at all. A robot is one place a program can be kept; plenty of robots run with no AI, and plenty of AI runs with no robot.

1.3 Learners: machines that improve from examples

So how does a video app get good at suggesting clips you like? Nobody wrote a rule for “show Aarav cricket clips”. Instead, the app **learned from examples** — millions of them. It noticed which clips people similar to you watched, and it found **patterns** in that. This is the big secret of this whole handout: a learning machine is not given the answer; it is given **examples**, and it works the pattern out by itself.

Here is the strange part: the people who build AI do not write the final rules either. **They choose the examples and the data**, and the machine does the pattern-finding. That is why the examples matter so much — feed a learner one-sided examples, and it learns a one-sided view of the world, exactly like the alien in your next mission.

T6-03 Teach the Alien

GROUP • 15 MIN

In your group of four, one person is the **Alien** — smart, but knowing nothing about Earth. The other three must teach the Alien the idea of **mango** using ONLY examples: point at real objects, drawings or the cards your teacher gives you, and say “mango” or “not mango”. No describing words allowed — aliens don’t speak Human! When the Alien starts guessing correctly, play the twist round: show **only green mangoes**. Then answer:

What wrong idea did our examples put in the Alien’s head?

How could we choose better examples next time?

WORD POWER • 3

Definition: artificial intelligence (AI)

Technology that lets machines do tasks that seem to need human intelligence.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

WORD POWER • 4

Definition: training examples

The examples we show a machine so that it can find patterns by itself.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

DETECTIVE'S NOTE

Machines **predict, match and estimate** — those are the verbs of AI. People **design** the system, **choose the data** and are **responsible** for what it does. Keep those verbs straight and you will never be fooled by a “smart machine” story.

1.4 Humans vs machines — the fair contest

So is a machine ever really smart? Try a fair contest. Machines are dazzling at some jobs: counting a million numbers without a mistake, noticing a pattern in a million examples, working all night without getting bored. People are dazzling at others: understanding a joke, knowing that your friend is sad from one look, deciding what is **fair**, asking a question nobody has asked

before. The contest has no overall winner — and that is exactly why people and machines make a good team, as long as the **people** stay in charge of the judging.

T6-04 Better At / Worse At

ALONE • 10 MIN

Fill the table, then your class votes for the most surprising idea.

Two things PEOPLE do better — and why	Two things MACHINES do better — and why

The class's most surprising idea was...

1.5 Three ways machines learn — three little stories

Machines learn in more than one way, and each way has a human story you already know. Watch for all three in this book.

STORY 1

Learning with labels

Show it, tell it. Like learning fruit names with flashcards: your teacher shows a card and says “mango”. The machine gets examples **with** answers attached — “this photo is a cat”, “this one is not”. It learns to match new photos to the labels.

STORY 2

Grouping without labels

Sort it your way. Like tidying a mixed toy box with no instructions: you make your own piles — colours here, shapes there. The machine gets examples with **no** answers and must find its own groups, like sorting customers or animals it has never been told about.

STORY 3

Trial and reward

Try it, score it. Like learning to ride a bicycle: wobble, fall, adjust, try again — and a happy feeling keeps you going. The machine tries actions, gets points for good ones, and slowly learns the moves that earn the most reward.

Real AI systems often mix all three. Class 7 will show you what each way is called — for now, the stories are enough.

DETECTIVE DRILL · WHICH STORY IS IT?

The learner...	Story 1, 2 or 3?
Leena learns dance by copying her teacher's moves, with a clap for each correct step.	
Irfan tidies a mixed pencil box by making his own piles — sharp ones here, colours there.	
A baby learns “dog” because everyone points and says “dog!” at every dog.	
A cricketer improves by trying shots, missing, adjusting — and loving the boundary!	

Self-check

shade one: first circle = not yet · middle = almost · last = got it

- ☐ I can point to a **rule-follower** and a **learner** in my own home, and say which is which ○○○
- ☐ I can explain “learning from examples” in my own words, without the book's help ○○○
- ☐ I can name one thing people do better than machines — and say **why** ○○○
- ☐ I can retell the three learning stories and match a new example to the right story ○○○

■ THINK & INK

One machine I use seemed really smart. Now I think it is a ... (rule-follower / learner), because ...

CASE NOTES — WHAT CHANGED IN MY THINKING?

Before this chapter I thought “smart machine” meant one thing. Now I know there are **two kinds**:

■ MYTH BUSTER

MYTH “AI is alive — it has feelings.”

TRUTH A learner finds patterns in numbers; it does not **feel** anything. When a chatbot writes “I am happy to help!”, that sentence was predicted from patterns in text people wrote. The **people** who design, choose data and take responsibility have the feelings — and the responsibility.

HOME LINK take this page home — no screen needed

T6-05 AI Detective at Home

HOME • 15 MIN

Walk through your **morning routine** like a detective. At each moment below, tick whether a machine with possible AI **may** hide there, and tick whether you think it **learns** from examples or just follows rules. Ask a grown-up if you are stuck — explaining your guess is part of the mission.

Moment in the morning	Possible AI? (✓)	Learns or follows rules?	What data might it use?
“Waking me up (alarm / phone)”			
“Brushing (electric brush / tap)”			
“Breakfast (microwave / kettle)”			
“Checking the day (weather app)”			
“Journey to school (bus / car / map)”			
“Buying something (shop / UPI / ATM)”			

My biggest surprise on this case:

2. Data: The Food of AI

GUIDING QUESTION

What do machines learn from — and what happens when the food is bad?

Machines cannot learn on empty stomachs — their food is **data**. You will hunt the four kinds of data around your classroom, tidy them into tables, turn a table into a chart, and then discover what happens when a learner is fed bad examples. Garbage in, garbage out — and only a detective can spot why.

MISSIONS T6-06 – T6-09
OUTCOMES 6.D1 • 6.D2 • 6.R2 **STRANDS**

D

Links: Maths — tables & bar graphs · Science — observation

In this chapter

2.1 Every learner needs food	17
2.2 Tables make data tidy	18
2.3 A picture is a grid of numbers	19
2.4 Garbage in, garbage out	21

2.1 Every learner needs food

You have learned that machines find patterns in examples. But what exactly do they look at?

Data. Data is the collected facts of the world — the numbers, words, pictures and sounds that we gather up and hand to a learner. Data is to AI what food is to your body: no learner can think without it, and a learner that eats bad food grows up weak and confused. A detective who understands data can predict exactly where an AI will do well — and where it will fall flat.

WORD POWER • 5

Definition: **data**

Collected facts about the world: numbers, words, pictures and sounds.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

DETECTIVE DRILL • WHICH KIND OF DATA?

The fact...	N	W	P	S
the temperature at 9 o'clock this morning				
your school anthem, sung in assembly				
a map of India on the classroom wall				
the words of your favourite poem				
a voice message from your grandmother				
the number of students absent today				

N = numbers • W = words • P = pictures • S = sounds. One row may fit two kinds — both ticks earn respect when you can say why.

T6-06 Four Kinds of Data Hunt

■ QUICK WIN PAIR • 10 MIN

Hunt your classroom (and your own pockets) for one example of each kind of data. Write or draw it in the box. The first pair to finish all four wins the round — but every box needs a real finding!

1 • NUMBERS

2 • WORDS

3 • PICTURES

4 • SOUNDS

One piece of data that could belong to TWO kinds at once:

2.2 Tables make data tidy

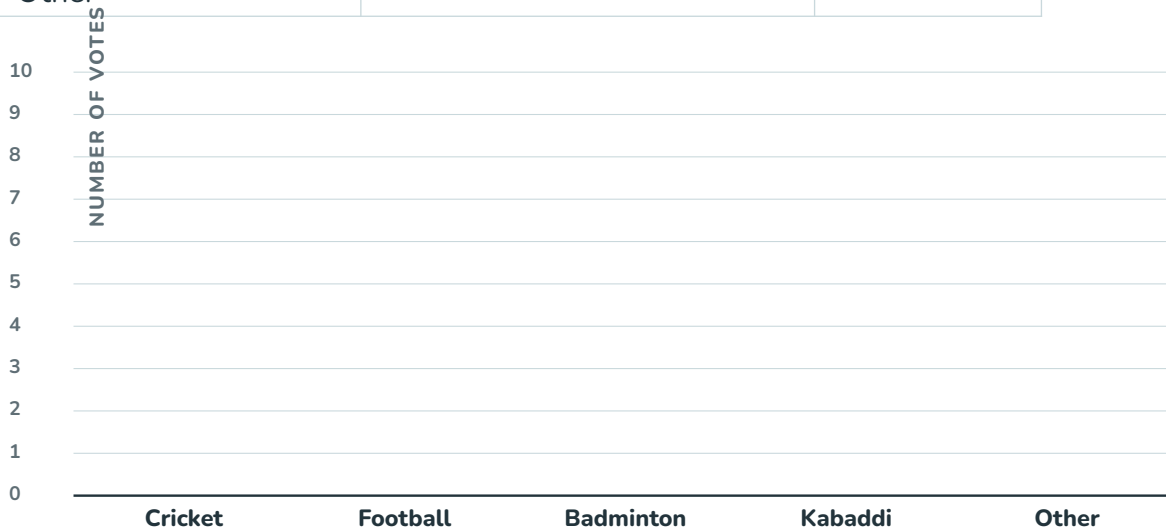
Loose data is like a scattered card pile: hard to think about. The first tool of every data detective is the **table** — rows and columns that line facts up neatly. Once data sits in a table, you can **tally** it (count with ||| strokes), and once you have tallies you can **draw a bar chart** that makes the biggest and smallest jump out at your eyes. Machines do exactly the same trick, only much faster: tidy first, then look.

T6-07 Table to Chart

GROUP • 15 MIN

In your group, ask each member: “Which of these five do you like best?” Add your teacher’s vote too if you like. Tally the answers, write the count, then colour one bar for each sport on the chart. Remember: one full tally is four strokes plus a strike-through.

Sport	Tally	Count
Cricket		
Football		
Badminton		
Kabaddi		
Other		



The tallest bar is ... because ...

One thing my chart proves, and one thing it cannot tell me:

2.3 A picture is a grid of numbers

Here is a secret that surprises almost everyone: to a camera and to an AI, your photograph is not a picture at all — it is a **huge grid of numbers**. Each tiny square of the image (a **pixel**) is stored as a number saying how bright or which colour it is. When you draw by numbers below, you are doing exactly what a camera does: turning a picture into numbers. Machines that “see” are really machines that are very good at finding patterns in those numbers.

0	1	1	1
1	0	0	0
1	0	0	0
0	1	1	1

A tiny 4 × 4 example. The zeros and ones store a letter — which one? Each row of the picture is one row of numbers. A real photo does this with millions of squares and numbers from 0 to 255 for brightness. **You** will speak “pixel language” in the next mission.

T6-08 Pixel Picture

PAIR • 15 MIN

How to play: Detective 1 keeps this page secret-ish and reads the code table aloud, row by row: “Row 1: 0 2 2 0 0 2 2 0 ...”. Detective 2 shades the left grid: 0 = leave white, 1 = shade light, 2 = shade dark. Then swap roles while Detective 1 shades the right grid. Finally reveal — do the two pictures match? That is data storage working!

0	2	2	0	0	2	2	0
2	1	1	2	2	1	1	2
2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
2	1	1	1	1	1	1	2
0	2	1	1	1	1	2	0
0	0	2	1	1	2	0	0
0	0	0	2	2	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

CODE CARD

0 = white
1 = light
2 = dark

REVEALED! What did the numbers turn into? **A picture on a screen is really just** _____ stored in a grid.

Our pictures matched? ☐ YES ☐ NO

DETECTIVE DRILL · READ THIS CHART

The garden club asked 25 members: “Which plant should we grow more of?” Their data, tidied into a chart:

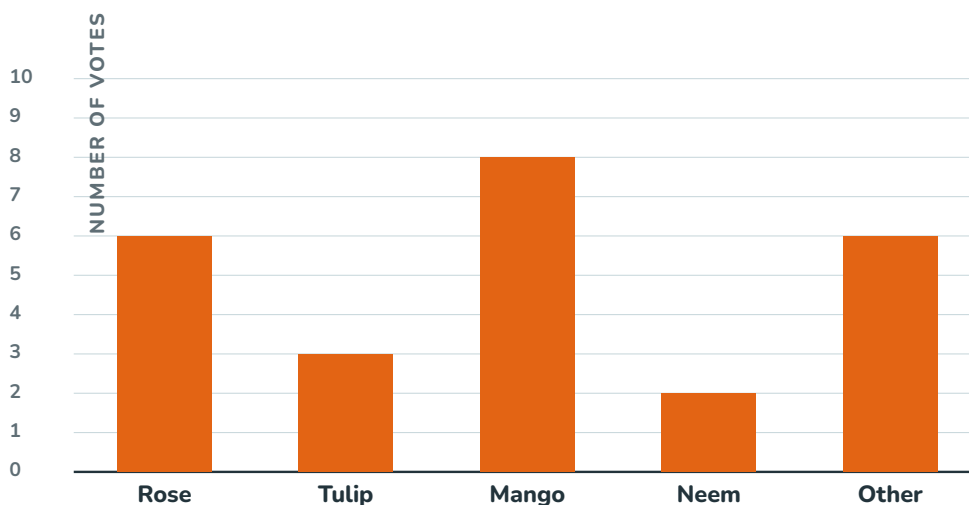


Chart question	My answer
Which plant won the vote? How do you know?	
How many more votes did Mango get than Tulip?	
A friend says “Tulip is the club’s favourite plant.” Is the chart on their side?	

2.4 Garbage in, garbage out

Now you can spot the biggest danger in an AI’s kitchen. If the **training examples** are wrong, messy or one-sided, the machine cannot know it — it will happily learn a wrong pattern and then **predict** wrong answers forever, with total confidence. Detectives have a saying for this: **garbage in, garbage out**. It is the number one reason a smart machine says something silly — not because the machine is broken, but because its food was bad.

■ MYTH BUSTER

MYTH “AI = computers = coding.”

TRUTH AI is an **idea** — learning patterns from data — and you can understand it fully with paper, as you just did. Not every computer runs AI (your calculator never learns), and AI is not the same as coding: coding writes fixed steps, while AI learns its own patterns from data.

T6-09 Garbage In, Garbage Out

GROUP • 10 MIN

Your group gets the eight **training cards** below (cut them out or copy them onto paper). One member is the **Machine**: cover the table, look only at the clues, and answer with the label that matches. The Machine announces its rule. Then the group tests the Machine with the three **test cards** at the bottom. Something will go wrong — good detectives find out why.

TRAINING CARDS — WHAT THE MACHINE SEES

Label on card	Clues on card
PET: CAT	whiskers · purrs · chases mice
PET: CAT	whiskers · sleeps a lot · soft fur
PET: DOG	barks · wags tail · fetches sticks
PET: CAT	barks · wags tail · fetches sticks
PET: COW	moos · eats grass · gives milk
PET: GOAT	bleats · eats everything · climbs
PET: HEN	clucks · lays eggs · scratches soil
PET: GOAT	moos · eats grass · gives milk

TEST CARDS — WHERE IT GETS EMBARRASSING

TEST 1

tiny puppy: barks · wags tail
Machine said: _____

TEST 2

kitten: whiskers · purrs
Machine said: _____

TEST 3

calf: moos · gives milk
Machine said: _____

The wrong rule our Machine learned:

Which training cards poisoned the learning? Circle them above. Why was the Machine fooled?

DETECTIVE'S NOTE

When an AI gives a wrong or unfair answer, do not just ask “what is wrong with the machine?” Ask the detective question: “**What is wrong with its data?**” One bad example in a million can still bend the pattern — that is why people must always stay in charge of checking.

CHAPTER 2 CLUES — SAY IT BACK

Data is the ...

Garbage in, garbage out means ...

A picture on a screen is really ...

Self-check

shade one: first circle = not yet · middle = almost · last = got it

- ☐ I can name the four kinds of data and point to one example of each in this classroom ○○○
- ☐ I can tidy data into a table, tally it, and draw a bar chart that others can read ○○○
- ☐ I can explain how a picture becomes a grid of numbers — and show it with my own code ○○○
- ☐ I can explain “garbage in, garbage out” to someone who missed today’s class ○○○

■ THINK & INK

A machine I know eats data all day long. The data it probably eats is ... and if that data is messy, it will ...

3. Patterns & Decisions

GUIDING QUESTION

How does a machine decide what to do next?

Patterns are the clues learners chase: find one, predict what comes next, and then say **how sure** you are. You will hunt number and letter patterns, play Guess My Rule with a hidden rule-keeper, trace an if-then decision machine, and debate answers whose confidence is higher than their accuracy.

MISSIONS T6-10 – T6-13
OUTCOMES 6.L1 • 6.T1 • 6.R2 **STRANDS**

L T

Links: Maths — number patterns · English — clear questions

In this chapter

3.1 Patterns are clues	25
3.2 Guess my rule	26
3.3 If-then: the question tree	28
3.4 How sure am I?	29
3.5 Chapter 3 wrap-up — my case summary	31

3.1 Patterns are clues

A detective's sharpest tool is not a magnifying glass — it is **noticing**. A pattern is something that repeats in a way you can spot and use: day after night after day, 2-4-6-8, the same chorus after each verse. Machines live on patterns. A learning machine studies its **training examples**, and every **pattern** it finds becomes a rule it can use to make a **prediction** — a smart guess about what comes next. Notice the order: first the pattern, then the prediction, then a guess about how sure it is. You will do all three in the next mission, exactly like a machine, on paper.

WORD POWER • 6

Definition: **pattern**

Something that repeats in a way we can spot, describe and use.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

WORD POWER • 7

Definition: **prediction**

A smart guess about what comes next, based on a pattern.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

T6-10 Pattern Hunt

ALONE • 10 MIN

For each strip: write what comes next, then shade how sure you are (one circle = a wild guess, two = fairly sure, three = I could defend it in court).

The clues	My prediction	How sure?
2 · 4 · 6 · 8 · ?		○○○
A · B · A · B · A · ?		○○○
● ■ ● ■ ● ■ ?		○○○
M · T · W · T · ? (days of the week!)		○○○
1 · 2 · 4 · 8 · ? (beware — this one doubles!)		○○○
J · F · M · A · ? (months!)		○○○

Which pattern fooled the most detectives in your class? Why?

A pattern from my own life (clap rhythm, bus timings, cricket over...):

■ MYTH BUSTER

MYTH “AI knows everything — it is always right.”

TRUTH A machine can only **predict** from patterns in the data it was given. If its data missed something, or was one-sided, it will make a wrong prediction — and still say it confidently. “Confident” and “correct” are two different words, and detectives never confuse them.

3.2 Guess my rule

Here is a party trick that is secretly machine learning. One player thinks of a secret rule — say, “only even numbers may pass”. The others **test** the rule by offering numbers, and the rule-keeper answers only YES or NO. Slowly, from these **labelled examples**, the players work out the hidden pattern. That is exactly how a learning machine trains: test, answer, adjust, test again. Play at least two rounds with different rule-keepers.

T6-11 **Guess My Rule**

GROUP • 15 MIN

One detective keeps a secret rule (examples your teacher may offer: **only even numbers** • **numbers bigger than 20** • **numbers with a 3 in them** • **the letter must be a vowel**). Everyone else offers tests and records them below. When you think you know it, write the rule and let the rule-keeper grade you with a tick or cross.

Example I offered	YES (allowed) or NO (not allowed)

Our final guess at the rule:

How many tests did we need before we were sure? Did any test mislead us?

DETECTIVE'S NOTE

Did you notice? You never **told** the rule-keeper's rule to the group — they learned it from labelled examples, just like a machine. And just like a machine, you might have learned a rule that is **nearly** right. More tests = more confidence.

DETECTIVE DRILL · TRACE THE MACHINE

This little machine sorts numbers using an exact **algorithm**. Trace each test number through it, step by step, and write what the machine answers.

THE MACHINE'S ALGORITHM

- 1 Look at the number.
- 2 If it is even, answer "E" and stop.
- 3 If it is odd **and** bigger than 10, answer "OB".
- 4 Otherwise, answer "OS".

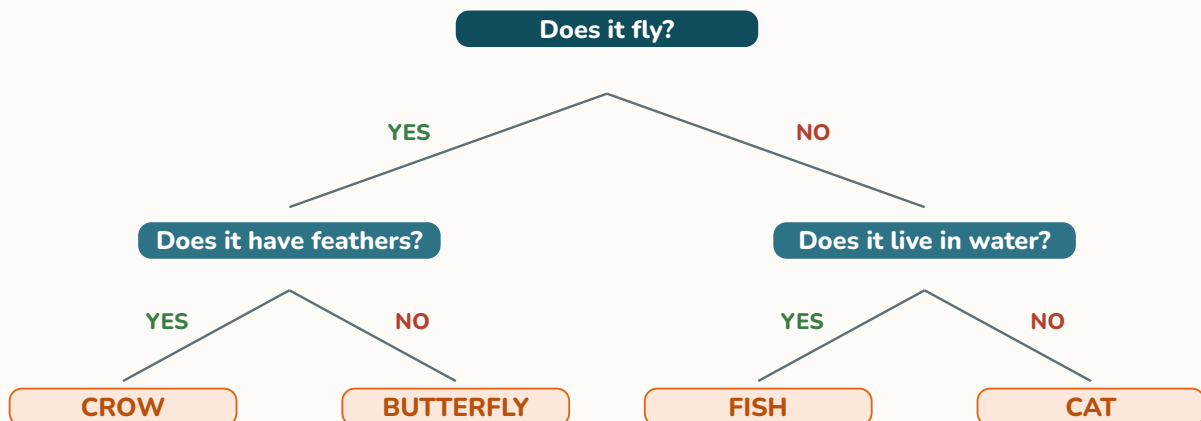
TEST IT WITH...

Test number	Machine's answer
7	
12	
23	
48	
9	

Which question should the machine ask FIRST to finish fastest — even, or bigger-than-10? Why?

3.3 If-then: the question tree

When a machine must **decide**, it often follows a chain of if-then questions: **if** the answer to Question 1 is yes, go left; **if** no, go right. You already use if-then thinking every day: **if** it is raining, take the umbrella; **if** the light is red, wait. People draw this chain as a **question tree**, and playing "20 Questions" is exactly this — each good question splits the possibilities in half. A question tree is also a kind of **algorithm**: exact steps that anyone — human or machine — can follow to the same answer. The better each question splits the suspects, the shorter the tree.



Your six suspects: **cow** • **crow** • **fish** • **snake** • **cat** • **frog**. Draw a yes/no question tree that tells all six apart. Start every branch from one top question. The pair whose tree needs the **fewest** questions on average wins the round.

DRAW YOUR QUESTION TREE HERE

Animal	Questions needed	Animal	Questions needed
Cow		Snake	
Crow		Cat	
Fish		Frog	

Our best first question (it split the suspects most evenly):

A question that turned out to be useless, and why:

3.4 How sure am I?

Real AI systems never just answer — they answer with a **confidence**: “cat, 62% sure”. Sometimes a machine is very confident and very wrong; sometimes it is unsure and right. People fall for the same trap: we shout answers we are proud of, and whisper the ones we doubt.

Detectives practise **saying how sure they are**, out loud, every single time. It is the thinking habit that keeps humans — not machines — in charge of the judging.

T6-13 **Sure or Not Sure?**

CLASS • 10 MIN

Your teacher reads six machine-style answers. For each one, mark its number on the confidence line where you think it belongs. Then the class debates the two that everyone placed differently.

#	The machine says...	Its claimed confidence
1	"The next number in 2-4-6-8 is 10."	95%
2	"This photo has a cat in it."	62%
3	"Tomorrow's highest temperature: 31°C."	78%
4	"Your name starts with the letter A."	40%
5	"This email is spam."	99%
6	"'Recieve' is the correct spelling."	97%
7	"Your class will have a test on Thursday."	55%
8	"The sun will rise tomorrow morning."	100%

Write each statement number where its confidence belongs →

0% — total guess

50%

100% — certain

Statement 6 was 97% confident — and wrong! One reason a confident answer can still be wrong:

CLASS DEBATE — THE TWO WE PLACED DIFFERENTLY

Statement numbers we argued about: _____ and _____ The argument was worth it because... _____

■ THINK & INK

When my first prediction today was wrong, the real reason was ... Next time before I answer, I will check by ...

3.5 Chapter 3 wrap-up — my case summary

MY PATTERN GALLERY — PATTERNS I NOTICED THIS WEEK

A PATTERN FROM NATURE OR ART

A PATTERN FROM HOME OR SCHOOL

A pattern I found and the prediction it let me make:

Self-check

shade one: first circle = not yet · middle = almost · last = got it

- | | |
|--|-----|
| ☐ I can find a pattern, predict what comes next, and say how sure I am | ○○○ |
| ☐ I can test a hidden rule with examples until I am confident — like a machine trains | ○○○ |
| ☐ I can draw a yes/no question tree that another pair can follow without my help | ○○○ |
| ☐ I can explain why a confident answer is not always a correct answer | ○○○ |

CHAPTER 3 CLUES — SAY IT BACK

A pattern is ...

A prediction is ...

Before I answer any question, I will say how ...

4. Be a Smart Digital Citizen

GUIDING QUESTION

How do I enjoy the online world — and stay safe, kind and honest?

Smart detectives stay safe, kind and honest — online as everywhere. You will sort personal information with a privacy traffic light, cook unguessable practice passphrases, run the three-check Real-or-Fake detector on suspect cards, and follow one drawing’s digital footprint as it travels the internet.

MISSIONS T6-14 – T6-17
OUTCOMES 6.R1 • 6.R2 **STRANDS**

R

Links: Social Science — community life · English — checking facts

In this chapter

4.1 Privacy: my information, my choice 34

4.2 Passphrases: long and strange wins 35

4.3 Real or fake? Be the detector 36

4.4 Your digital footprint 38

4.1 Privacy: my information, my choice

Every time you use a game, an app or a website, somebody is collecting **data** — and some of that data is **about you**. Your name, your school, your street, your photos, even your jokes: this is **personal information**, and you get to decide who may see it. **Privacy** means keeping personal things shared only on purpose, with people you trust. Machines that learn from data cannot judge what **should** stay private — that judgement is a human job, and from today it is yours.

WORD POWER • 8

Definition: **privacy**

Keeping personal information shared only on purpose, with people you trust.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

T6-14 Privacy Traffic Light

ALONE • 10 MIN

Sort the ten items into three lights. GREEN = okay to share freely • YELLOW = ask a grown-up first • RED = never share with apps, strangers or websites. Write each item's number in the right column.

The ten items

1 my favourite colour • 2 my full name and school • 3 a photo of my home street • 4 my favourite game • 5 my phone number • 6 a drawing I made of a cat • 7 my home address • 8 my best friend's secret • 9 my password • 10 my class timetable

GREEN

share freely

YELLOW

ask a grown-up first

RED

never share

One item was hard to place, because...

DETECTIVE'S NOTE

Strangers online are exactly like strangers anywhere: mostly ordinary people, sometimes not. The rule does not change — personal information goes only to people your grown-ups trust, no matter how friendly a screen looks.

4.2 Passphrases: long and strange wins

A short password like `riya123` is cracked in seconds by a machine that simply tries every combination — that machine is doing **automation**, fixed steps, millions per minute. What defeats it is a **passphrase**: three or more **unrelated** words glued together, long enough that guessing would take centuries. The strange words do not need to make sense — they need to be **long, unrelated to you, and known only by you**.

T6-15 Password Recipe

PAIR • 10 MIN

Cook up a **practice** passphrase using the recipe: pick one word from each column, add your favourite two-digit number and a symbol. Example: “Rickshaw-Monsoon-Pencil-42!”. Write it, then rate it. **Never write your real password anywhere — and never show this page’s passphrase to anyone outside your pair.**

Pick one from each column	A	B	C
	Rickshaw	Monsoon	Pencil
	Cricket	Thunder	Mango
	Peacock	Banyan	Lantern
	Kite	Pepper	Compass

Our practice passphrase:

Two reasons it is strong:

Too weak: names, birthdays, phone numbers, “123456”, your favourite team — machines guess these first.

Strong: 12+ characters, unrelated words, mixed with numbers and symbols, changed if ever shared.

DETECTIVE DRILL • RATE THESE TWO PRACTICE PASSPHRASES

The practice passphrase	Strong or weak?	Why?
riya123		
Rickshaw-Monsoon-Pencil-42!		
AJAY2015		
Green-Onion-Tiger-77?		

4.3 Real or fake? Be the detector

The online world is full of edited photos, forwarded rumours and — increasingly — pictures and text made by AI. None of this means the internet is bad; it means every good detective needs a

checking routine. Professionals call it **verification**, and it needs only three questions: **Where is it from? (source)** · **What is the evidence?** · **How does it try to make me feel?** If a message makes your heart race — fear, anger, “forward this NOW!” — that rushing feeling is exactly when you should slow down and verify.

WORD POWER • 9

Definition: verify

To check carefully whether something is true, using evidence and trusted sources.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

DETECTIVE'S NOTE — AI ANSWERS CAN BE WRONG

An AI answer can be wrong for a simple reason: the machine **predicts** from patterns in its training data, it does not **know** things the way people do. If its data was one-sided, messy or old, its answer will show it. One way to check any answer — human or machine: **verify with a second source** before you believe or forward it.

T6-16 Real or Fake Detective

GROUP • 15 MIN

Your teacher shows three printed cards (or use these three suspects). Apply the three checks to each: **source** • **evidence** • **emotion**. Give a verdict: REAL, FAKE, or NOT SURE — and “not sure” is an honest detective’s answer when evidence is missing!

CARD A

A photo of a dog — but it has five legs and very odd fur.
Forwarded with “Amazing new breed!”

CARD B

“Forward this to 10 friends in 10 minutes or your account will be closed tomorrow!!!”

CARD C

A poster claims “Scientists say our city’s air is the cleanest ever” — with no scientist’s name, no date, no source.

Card	Our verdict (REAL / FAKE / NOT SURE)	Which check helped most?
A		
B		
C		

One thing on this page that a machine might believe but a detective should doubt:

DESIGN ONE MORE SUSPECT CARD — SWAP WITH ANOTHER PAIR AND DETECT THEIRS!

4.4 Your digital footprint

Imagine walking on a beach of soft sand: every step leaves a mark, and some marks stay long after you have gone. Everything you post, like, share or search leaves a mark too — a **digital footprint**. Footprints are not automatically bad: your kind comments and your good work can travel far and make people smile. But a footprint is hard to erase — one screenshot, one forward, and a moment you meant for two friends can be standing in front of a whole school. Post like the whole world is watching, because one day it might be.

WORD POWER • 10

Definition: **digital footprint**

The trail of marks you leave behind when you post, like, share or search online.

Say it three times today — it sticks!

T6-17 Footprint Walk

ALONE • 10 MIN

Follow one imaginary post — “You post a drawing for the school contest” — and watch it travel. For each hop, note **who can see it now** and whether you could still take it back.

Hop	Who can see my drawing now?	Can I take it back? (YES / NO)
1 · I post it for the contest		
2 · My class group forwards it		
3 · My teacher saves it for the website		
4 · The school website shows it		
5 · A cousin shares it to family far away		
6 · Unknown accounts copy it		

One habit that keeps a footprint kind and small:

My footprint promise this month:

DETECTIVE DRILL • WRITE THE KIND REPLY

A classmate posts one of these in the class group. What is a kind, helpful reply? Write one — it must pass the T.H.I.N.K. check!

The post...	My kind reply
“I came last in the spelling test. I am so bad at everything.”	
“Look at this photo I took of our school garden!”	
“Nobody wants to be my science partner.”	

Before you post — run the T.H.I.N.K. check

T

Is it True?

H

Is it Helpful?

I

Is it Inspiring?

N

Is it Necessary?

K

Is it Kind?

If any answer is **NO** — hold the post, detective. Screens can be big; kindness is bigger.

MY FIVE SAFETY HABITS — SAY THEM OUT LOUD

1

Private info stays
private

2

Long, strange
passphrases

3

Think before posting

4

Be kind — always

5

Check before believing

■ MYTH BUSTER

MYTH “Bigger screen = smarter machine.”

TRUTH Smartness comes from **data and patterns**, not screen size. A tiny speaker can run a powerful learner, and a giant TV can be completely ordinary. Judge a machine by what it **learned from** — never by how big it looks.

Self-check

shade one: first circle = not yet · middle = almost · last = got it

- | | |
|--|---------|
| ☐ I can sort personal information into share / ask-first / never-share, and explain why | ○ ○ ○ ○ |
| ☐ I can build a strong practice passphrase — and I know never to write my real one down | ○ ○ ○ ○ |
| ☐ I can run the three checks (source · evidence · emotion) on anything doubtful | ○ ○ ○ ○ |
| ☐ I can explain my digital footprint to a younger student in two sentences | ○ ○ ○ ○ |
| ☐ I use the T.H.I.N.K. check before I post — and I can prove it | ○ ○ ○ ○ |

■ THINK & INK

One habit I will start this week is ... because last week I saw / did ...

5. My Neighbourhood AI Investigation

GUIDING QUESTION

What can I discover about AI near me — using my own data?

Your biggest case yet: a **real survey** of five grown-ups about the smart machines around them. You will plan and run the survey, organise and chart the data you collect, design a helper machine of your own — and then close the case by answering the big question from page one, with evidence.

MISSIONS **T6-18 – T6-20**
OUTCOMES **6.U1 • 6.D1 • 6.W1 • 6.R2** STRANDS

U D L W R

Links: Social Science — community survey · Maths — data & charts

In this chapter

5.1 Run a real survey 42

5.2 Design a helper machine 44

5.3 Close the case 45

YOUR BIGGEST CASE YET — READ THIS FIRST!

Every skill from Chapters 1–4 comes together here. In groups, you will run a **real survey** with five grown-ups, organise the **data** you collect, draw it, and present findings — then design a helper machine of your own. It takes 2–3 class periods plus home time. Detectives work carefully: one sloppy column can spoil a whole investigation.

5.1 Run a real survey

GROUP ROLES — DECIDE BEFORE YOU GO

Role	Detective
Asker — asks the questions politely	
Recorder — writes the answers down	
Checker — re-reads each row for mistakes	
Presenter — shares the findings with the class	

SURVEY MANNERS — READ BEFORE YOU KNOCK

Ask first: “Do you have two minutes to help our class project?” **Listen** without interrupting — a rush recorder misses data. **Write initials only** — never a neighbour’s full name. **Say thank you**, even when the answer is “no”. **No photos, no recordings, no personal details** — our survey is paper-only.

Step 1 • Plan. As a group, agree whom you will ask: five adults — a family member, a neighbour, a shopkeeper, a teacher, anyone safe and willing. The question: **“Where do you meet machines that seem smart in your daily life?”** Write your plan before you collect:

We will ask (roles, not names):

We will collect our data on (day/place), so the survey is safe and polite because...

Step 2 • Collect. Record one line per person. Ask the follow-up: **“What does it probably learn from?”** — that is its data.

Who (initials only)	The smart machine they named	What data might it use?	Rule-follower or learner?

Step 3 • Organise. Tally your group’s five answers into the families below, then draw the bars.

Family	Tally
Phone & video apps	
Voice assistants	
Shops, banks & payments	
Travel & traffic	
Somewhere else	



Step 4 • Findings — finish the sentences like a real analyst:

5.2 Design a helper machine

T6-19 My Helper Machine — the poster

GROUP • 2 periods MIN

Design (on paper!) one machine that would genuinely help people you know. Fill the case sheet, then make a poster your class can judge.

MACHINE NAME

THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES (who struggles, with what?)

WHO WILL USE IT

ONE HONEST LIMIT — “it cannot ... because ...”

- ☐ **RULE-FOLLOWER** — it runs an algorithm we write: exact if-then steps, same every time.
- ☐ **LEARNER** — it studies training examples and finds its own pattern.

Tick one. Every helper machine is one of these two — choosing well is the designer's first job.

WHAT DATA DOES IT EAT? TICK ALL THAT APPLY

- ☐ Numbers — prices, times, counts
- ☐ Words — names, questions, messages
- ☐ Pictures — photos, drawings, maps
- ☐ Sounds — voice, music, alarms

SKETCH YOUR HELPER MACHINE — LABEL THE DATA GOING IN AND THE HELP COMING OUT

HOW YOUR POSTER WILL BE JUDGED — REASONING EARNS MORE THAN ART

Level	What it looks like
Beginning	A machine is named, but the problem, data or limit is missing.
Growing	The problem and data are clear, but the limit is missing — every real machine has one!
Secure	Problem, users, data and an honest limit all make sense together.
Shining	Everything in Secure, plus the group defended their choices with evidence from their survey — and said where the machine could fail.

5.3 Close the case

T6-20 I used to think... Now I think...

ALONE • 10 MIN

The last mission of the case: look back at page 1's big question and at everything your pencil went through.

I USED TO THINK

NOW I THINK

Three questions I still have for my next case (Class 7):

★ Detective badge earned: LEVEL 1 • NOTICE — you can now see where AI is, and **CASE CLOSED** tell it from ordinary machines.

My AI words

The ten words on this case — each one met through an experience, never before.

1 algorithm

An exact list of steps that tells a machine how to do a task, one step at a time.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

2 automation

Work done by a machine that repeats fixed steps in the same way every time.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

3 artificial intelligence

Technology that lets machines do tasks that seem to need human intelligence.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

4 training examples

The examples we show a machine so that it can find patterns by itself.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

5 data

Collected facts about the world: numbers, words, pictures and sounds.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

6 pattern

Something that repeats in a way we can spot, describe and use.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

7 prediction

A smart guess about what comes next, based on a pattern.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

8 privacy

Keeping personal information shared only on purpose, with people you trust.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

9 verify

To check carefully whether something is true, using evidence and trusted sources.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

10 digital footprint

The trail of marks you leave behind when you post, like, share or search online.

USE IT IN MY OWN SENTENCE: _____

DETECTIVE'S OATH

Machines **predict, match, estimate** — people **design, choose data and stay responsible**. When a machine speaks, I will ask my three questions: **How do I know? What is missing? Who made this?**

My progress

Shade honestly — detectives never fake evidence.

MY OUTCOME TRACKER — TICK WHEN YOU TRULY CAN DO IT

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ 6.U1 — say what AI is, and tell a learner from a fixed-rule machine | ☐ 6.L2 — describe the three ways of learning with human stories |
| ☐ 6.U2 — name two human strengths and two machine strengths, with reasons | ☐ 6.W1 — point to AI at home, school and neighbourhood, and name its data |
| ☐ 6.D1 — name the four kinds of data; sort a table; draw a bar chart | ☐ 6.R1 — use my five safety habits — every day, not just today |
| ☐ 6.D2 — show how a simple picture becomes numbers on a grid | ☐ 6.R2 — explain why an AI answer can be wrong, and how to check it |
| ☐ 6.L1 — find a pattern, predict the next step, say how sure I am | ☐ 6.T1 — break a task into exact steps another person can follow |

MY CASE FILES — SHADE A STAR PER CHAPTER FINISHED

1 Machines · 2 Data · 3 Patterns · 4 Digital Citizen · 5 Capstone



PRATIMAI · AI HANDOUTS · CLASS 6

My AI Detective Certificate

This certifies that detective

DETECTIVE NAME

has completed the case file “AI Around Me” — Level 1 · NOTICE — solved all twenty missions, and promised to keep asking: **How do I know? · What is missing? · Who made this?**

DATE

DETECTIVE'S SIGNATURE

GUIDE'S SIGNATURE

Ready for the next case? Class 7 asks: “How can a machine learn without being told the rules?” — bring your badge.